

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

A world map with a light blue background. Dashed blue lines radiate from India, connecting it to various countries across the globe, including the United States, Canada, Mexico, Central America, the Caribbean, South America, Africa, the Middle East, China, Mongolia, and Southeast Asia. The text 'NEHRU'S FOREIGN POLICY' is overlaid in large, bold, dark red letters.

NEHRU'S FOREIGN POLICY

MODULE – 3

HUNGARIAN CRISIS

- 1** The Hungarian Revolution of 1956 or the Hungarian Uprising of 1956 was a nationwide revolt against the government of the Hungarian People's Republic and its Soviet-imposed policies.
- 2** The revolt spread quickly across Hungary and the government collapsed. Because of public opinion, the government wanted to withdraw from USSR led Warsaw pact.
- 3** The Soviet force invaded areas of Hungary and suppressed public opinion.
- 4** India's opinion in this situation was different from Suez crisis. Instead of being requested to pressurize Soviet Union to withdraw forces, it choose to remain silent for a long time.



HUNGARIAN CRISIS

- 5 Three weeks later it made a statement saying Hungarians had the right of self-determination and the Soviets ought to recognise Hungarian sovereignty
- 6 Critics allege that it was a violation of the principles of non-alignment. Some realists however are of the opinion that India was looking for Soviet support in its border issues with Pakistan and China.
- 7 USA was supporting Pakistan through arms and humanitarian support. Moreover it was felt that support for Hungary might raise demands for freedom for the state of J&K.
- 8 Hence its national interests and principles of realism might have been the reason for such stance.



KOREAN CRISIS

- 1** The Korean War was another important issue that led to the deteriorating relations between India and China and questioned the principles of NAM.
- 2** North Korea, backed by USSR invaded South Korea. US intervened as a part of its containment of Communism policy.
- 3** In 1953, China also engaged its troops in Korean War. When the peace was restored in Korea, a large numbers of troops were moved into Tibet.



KOREAN CRISIS

- 4 The large-scale deployment of Chinese troops along the Indo-Tibetan border posed great threat to India's security and integrity.
- 5 India by its position as the Chairman of the Neutral Repatriation Commission (NNRC) of the war prisoners had to undertake the job repatriating the war prisoners in Korea.
- 6 China alleged that India, being partisan, sided with the Americans on the prisoners of war in Korea. This again heightened the tension in the Sino-Indian relations.



CUBAN MISSILE CRISIS

- 1** Cuba was an ally of the Soviet Union and received both diplomatic and financial aid from it.
- 2** The problem arose when Soviet Union decided to convert Cuba into a Russian base by placing nuclear missiles in 1962.
- 3** This threatened American bases and US president prepared its warships to be prepared for any military action from Russia.



CUBAN MISSILE CRISIS

4 This evident clash came to be known as the Cuban Missile Crisis.

5 The Cuban Missile Crisis was a 13-day (October 16-28, 1962) confrontation between the United States and the Soviet Union concerning American ballistic missile deployment in Italy and Turkey with consequent Soviet ballistic missile deployment in Cuba.

6 This event was the closest the Cold War came to escalating into a full-scale nuclear war.



ASIAN GIANTS

- 1** Along with India, China got independence in 1949. Asia now had two big independent nations. Culturally, politically and socially, India and China were different.
- 2** China underwent a civil war to gain independence which was different from India's path. China was also different from India with regards to political ideology. It was an underdeveloped Communist dictatorship.
- 3** PM Nehru wanted the developing nations to function without the interference of the superpowers. China under Mao wanted the Third World to bring a global revolution under the leadership of China.



ASIAN GIANTS

- 4 India saw China's independence as the 'great Asian Resurgence' and wanted to support her cause. It also supported China's entry into UN.
- 5 Instead of looking inwards and consolidating and reorganizing itself like India, China began its expansionist policies.
- 6 Hence since independence, China and India were engaged in a competition for influence. Thus, relations started deteriorating between neighbours, culminating into the 1962 Indo-China war.



SHORT BONHOMIE

1 According to India, the bilateral relationship between India and China was based on the principles of 'Panchsheel', as it providing a lasting solution for peace and stability in Asia.

2 In the mid-1950s, China and India came together in the spirit of "Hindi Chini Bhai Bhai" (India and China are brothers).



TIBETAN ISSUE

1 China claimed sovereignty over Tibet on January 1, 1950, and intended to intervene both politically and militarily in the affairs of Tibet.

2 It invaded Tibet on October 7, 1950, and Chinese troops captured Chamdo on October 19, 1950. This annexation removed the historical buffer between India and China.

3 Tibet requested military assistance from India. The Dalai Lama travelled on an official visit to India from November 1956 to February 1957.

4 The spiritual leader of Tibet, the Dalai Lama, referred the matter to the United Nations on November 11, 1950. On December 18, 1956, the UN General Assembly approved a resolution calling for the end of Chinese repression against the Tibetans.



PM NEHRU VISITED CHINA

- 1 With the hope of establishing a bilateral relationship, PM Nehru visited Beijing and met Mao Zedong in October 1954.
- 2 India and China did not discuss the annexation of Tibet but inclusion of territories of India and Burma being included in Chinese maps was mentioned.
- 3 China's official maps laid claims over Aksai Chin and Arunachal Pradesh. When countered about Chinese claims, the then Premier Zhou said that there were errors in those maps.
- 4 The inability of the Buddhist pilgrims to go to pilgrimage was also mentioned by PM Nehru but China ignored those concerns



INDIA ON THE WRONG SIDE OF CHINA

- 1 China's brutal suppression continued in Tibet.
- 2 PM Nehru expressed support for Tibetan rebels on March 30, 1959. It felt China should have responded peacefully instead of resorting to violence
- 3 The Dalai Lama and some 80 supporters fled into exile in India on March 31, 1959.



CHINA'S SUSPICIONS

- 1** The Chinese government alleged that India instigated rebellion in Tibet. It claimed that Tibet was an integral part of China and the riots were an internal problem of China.
- 2** China also alleged that India was allowing and encouraging anti-Chinese activities when it gave asylum to Dalai Lama.
- 3** The Chinese responded by increasing their military presence in the border area, border skirmishes in August and October 1959 led to deaths of several Indian border guards.



1962 WAR

China's expansionist policies did not stop at Tibet.

1 It proclaimed that the entire Himalayan region was part of its sovereign territory and refused to acknowledge McMahon Line as the eastern border between India and China and also laid claims on parts of Jammu and Kashmir.

2 In 1958, India officially stated that Aksai Chin was its territory.

3 India responded by launching its Forward Policy in 1961. Its objective was to create outposts behind advancing Chinese troops and force them to retreat.

4 Army was deployed at several posts. India never believed that China would launch a full-fledged war.

5 But the People's Liberation Army of China invaded Ladakh and Arunachal Pradesh (then known as the North East Frontier Agency) and India-China war began on October 20, 1962.



1962 WAR

- 6** On October 20, 1962 China launched simultaneous attacks on Indian posts in Arunachal Pradesh and Ladakh.
- 7** The Indian army was ill-prepared and poorly equipped. This helped the Chinese to advance easily.
- 8** Zhou Enlai proposed a peace-deal to relinquish claim over Arunachal Pradesh if India would give it Askai Chin.
- 9** Nehru rejected the proposal on the ground that China lacked legitimate claim over these territories.



1962 WAR

10 Soviet Union also stated that McMahon Line was a product of British imperialism, as China had claimed earlier. Moreover, because of the Cuban Missile Crisis coinciding, India did not get any assistance from the superpowers.

11 After three weeks, China declared a unilateral ceasefire on 21 November and withdrew from Indian territories.

12 Around 3,250 Indian soldiers were killed. India lost about 43,000 square kilometres of land in Aksai Chin.



ASSESSMENT

- 1** The 1962 war was an eye-opener for India, in general and PM Nehru in particular.
- 2** India felt an urgent need to modernize its Defence infrastructure. Nuclear policy soon became a part of India's defence strategy.
- 3** The war affected India's stature on the world stage. Nehru was criticized for incorrect assessment of the situation and its military preparedness.



INDO-US RELATIONS UNDER PM NEHRU

- 1** US-led South East Asia Treaty Organisation (SEATO) and Central Treaty Organisation (CENTO) increased its presence in South Asia to counter the spread of Communism.
- 2** US provided military aid to Pakistan when Pakistan joined the treaty organizations.
- 3** These Cold War tensions further influenced relations between India and Pakistan. India further distanced itself from US when it provided military aid and weapons to Pakistan.



INDIA'S ROLE IN INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTIONS

1

Nehru, a western educated, believed in the functioning and fairness of international organisations.

2

This is evident from the following actions

- In spite of J&K signing the Instrument of Accession to India, PM Nehru continued to consider it as a disputed state and took the issue to the UN for its resolution. UN however disappointed India by entangling the issue with Cold War situation.
- UN also took up the issue of Soviet intervention in Hungary. India voted against the UN resolution which condemned military action.



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